

3-Way Client Session Manager

User Guide (v1.0)

1. Overview

The **3-Way Client Session Manager (3-Way CSM)** is a Windows desktop utility that centrally manages SSH/SFTP sessions and launches one of three external clients:

- **Tera Term** (SSH with optional macro support)
- **PuTTY** (SSH)
- **WinSCP** (SFTP)

The application does **not modify** these third-party tools. It simply launches them with the correct command-line parameters.

Key goals:

- Store frequently used session definitions in a single manager for 3 clients
- Optional auto-login with saved credentials
- One-click launch into SSH or SFTP
- Optional Tera Term macro selection
- Simple backup rotation of session data

Notes:

Sessions are stored inside the %APPDATA%\teraterm5\ folder so Teraterm **MUST** be installed before 3-Way CSM can be used! PuTTY and Win SCP are add-on options that may share the same manager.

2. System Requirements

Operating System

- Windows (32-bit or 64-bit; tested paths suggest Windows 10/11)

Required External Programs

At least **one** of the following must be installed:

- **3-Way_CSM**
 - Default path:
 - C:\Accessories\3-Way_CSM
- **Tera Term (*Mandatory before use*)**
 - Expected paths:
 - C:\Program Files\teraterm5\ttermpro.exe
OR
 - C:\Program Files (x86)\teraterm5\ttermpro.exe
- **PuTTY**
 - Searched in:
 - Application folder
 - C:\Program Files\PuTTY\putty.exe
 - C:\Program Files (x86)\PuTTY\putty.exe
OR
 - portable sharing the same 3-Way_CSM folder
- **WinSCP (portable only)**
 - Expected default:
 - portables sharing the same 3-Way_CSM folder

If a client is not found, its option is automatically disabled in the UI.

3. Installation

****The 3-Way CSM executable fully expects TerraTerm is pre-installed.****

1. Place the **3-Way CSM executable** in its own folder (recommended).
2. Ensure TeraTerm client is installed. Sessions are stored in the %appdata%\teraterm5 folder
3. (Optional) Place `putty.exe` in the 3-Way_CSM folder.
4. (Optional) Place `WinSCP.exe` in the 3-Way_CSM folder.
5. Launch the application.

⚠ Only **one instance** of 3-Way CSM is allowed. If already running, the existing window will be brought to the foreground.

4. Main Window Layout

Left Pane

- **Session List**
 - Displays saved sessions
 - Format:
 - Name, IP_Address, Port [TAB] encrypted_password [TAB] encrypted_username

Right Pane

- **Client Selection** (only one allowed)
 - ☐ Tera Term
 - ☐ PuTTY
 - ☐ WinSCP
 - **Session Fields**
 - **Title** – Friendly session name
 - **Address** – numeric IP address
 - **Port#** – Defaults to 22
 - **UserName** (optional)
 - **Password** (optional)
 - **Controls**
 - [SAVE]
 - [CONNECT]
 - [ping]
 - [Sessions Folder]
 - [?] Help
 - [About]
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5. Creating a New Session

1. Enter:
 - **Title**
 - **Address**
 - **Port** (optional, defaults to 22)
 - **UserName** (optional)
 - **Password** (optional)
2. Enable **[User/Pswd OK]** if you want credentials saved.
3. Click **[SAVE]**.

Notes

- If **Title** Already exists the record will be modified when saved. If **Title** is new, a new session will be created when saved.
 - If **User/Pswd OK** is unchecked, credentials will **not** be saved.
 - Sessions are updated if the session name already exists.
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6. Connecting to a Session

Method 1: Button

1. Select a session from the list.
2. Click **[CONNECT]**.

Method 2: Keyboard

- Select a session and press **Enter**.

What Happens

- Depending on the selected client:
 - **PuTTY** launches SSH session
 - **Tera Term** launches SSH session with selected optional macro
 - **WinSCP** launches using an `sftp` session
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7. Client-Specific Behavior

PuTTY Mode

- Uses SSH2 only
- Password auto-login only works if **User/Pwd OK** is enabled.
- Window title includes session name and IP.

Tera Term Mode

- Uses SSH2 only
- Password auto-login only works if **User/Pwd OK** is enabled.
- Window title includes session name and IP.
- Automatically scans for `.ttl` macro files at launch in:
%APPDATA%\teraterm5\
- Macro files appear as radio buttons.
- Selected macro is passed when new session is launched.
Can be used for automating tasks with carefully designed ttl macro scripts.
- Session opens using SSH2 with optional password auto-login.

WinSCP Mode

- Uses SFTP only.
 - Creates/updates `winscp.ini` with defaults if needed.
 - Credentials are passed via URL when allowed.
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8. Password Handling

- Usernames and passwords can be optionally stored with each session.
- Credential storage is **encrypted**, not stored in plain text.
- Saved credentials are only used to support **auto-login** when launching supported clients.
- Credential use is controlled by the **[User/Pswd OK]** checkbox:
 - **Enabled:** credentials may be saved and passed automatically to the selected client.
 - **Disabled:** credentials are not used for auto-login and must be entered manually.

Password Visibility

- The **[Show Password]** option temporarily reveals or masks the username and password fields in the UI.
- This affects display only and does not change how credentials are stored.

Security Notes

- When auto-login is enabled, credentials are passed to the selected client, which performs the actual network authentication.
- All connections are handled directly by the selected third-party client (Tera Term, PuTTY, or WinSCP).
- Users remain responsible for securing access to the workstation where session data is stored.

Best Practice:

Use auto-login only on trusted systems and disable **[User/Pswd OK]** if manual authentication is preferred.

9. Session Storage & Backups

Sessions are stored in:

`%APPDATA%\teraterm5\Sessions`

Automatic Backup Rotation

On every save:

1. Sessions → Sessions1
2. Sessions1 → Sessions2
3. Old Sessions2 is deleted

This provides **two generations of rollback**.

10. Managing Sessions

Delete a Session

1. Click a session in the list.
2. Press **Delete** on the keyboard.

Edit a Session

1. Click the session.
2. Modify fields.
3. Click **[SAVE]**.

Beware:

Modifying the **Title** will result in new session creation. If you must modify the **Title** then you must remember to manually delete the old session.

11. Ping Test

- Click **[ping]** to test reachability.
 - Uses Windows `ping.exe` with one packet.
 - Displays success/failure message.
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12. Sessions Folder Button

- Opens File Explorer and highlights the active `Sessions` file.
 - Useful for backups or manual edits.
 - This is Also where the `.ttl` macro files are expected for TeraTerm.
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13. Help Window (?)

Provides:

- Usage instructions
- Explanation of **[User/Pswd OK]** checkbox
- Session file rotation details
- Link to TermTerm macro documentation

Press **any key** to close the help window.

14. About Window

Includes:

- Version information
 - Legal disclaimers
 - Hyperlinks to:
 - Tera Term homepage & license
 - PuTTY homepage & license
 - WinSCP homepage & license
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15. Known Limitations

- TeraTerm Macros Selection Limited to 8 total
 - IPv6 not supported
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16. Intended Use

This tool is ideal for:

- Network administrators
- Support technicians and engineers
- Lab environments
- Gateway (Jump) Server